Things to remember when you write your dissertation ..

Background

To be able to fully understand and appreciate the multiplicity of the IS audit profession and IS auditing concepts, it is essential to determine and define the existing body of knowledge by means of a literature review. The literature review aim to set the background for the study as well as to contribute to a framework defining an IS auditor's profile. In order to define an IS auditor's profile, the roles and responsibilities, knowledge, skills and audit tools and techniques used in performing an IS audit ~~is~~ are illustrated. In this chapter, the evolution of the IS auditing profession are first described, in order to ~~To be able to~~ illustrate ~~understand~~ the IS auditing concepts and the differences between traditional audit, IT and IS audit~~, the evolution of the IS auditing profession will firstly be described~~. ~~–~~Thereafter the IS auditing concept definitions, as obtained from the literature, ~~will be~~are determined and defined. These concepts' definitions ~~will~~ set the outline for the detailed descriptions of the 5 components defining the IS auditor's profile, namely:

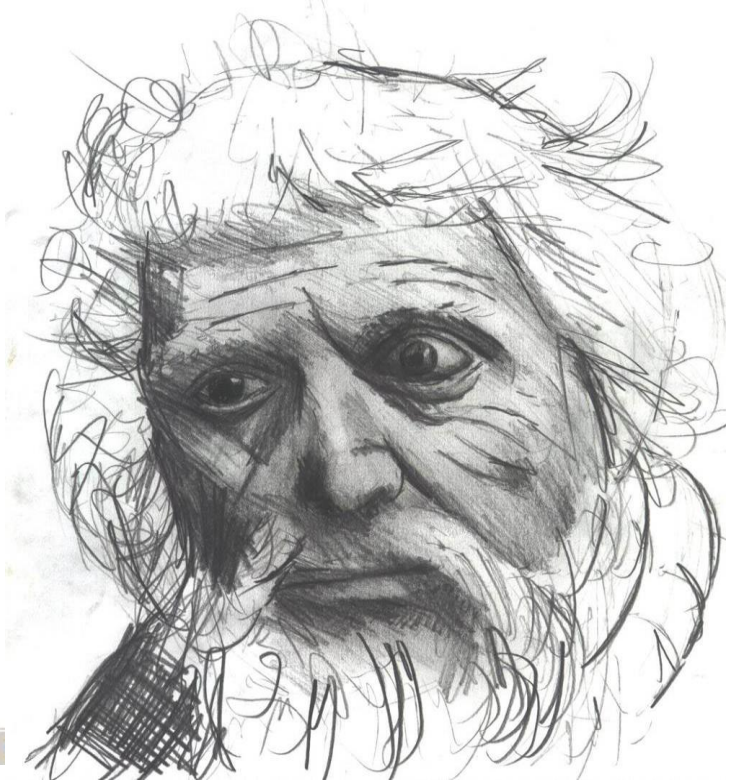
1. The IS auditor's daily roles and responsibilities and the main stages in performing a typical IS audit assignment;
2. The knowledge expected from an IS auditor regarding IT concepts;

Comment [MSOffice3]: Begin eerder. In order to understand

Comment [MSOffice4]: The aim of the literature review is to …

Comment [MSOffice5]: Ek het die vorige sin vir jou verander om die will uit te haal. Moet nie will be en will gebruik nie. Maak die sinne passive current tense soos wat ek in die vorige sin gemaak het.

YOUR MOST IMPORTANT TASK DURING WRITING IS TO WRITE WITH YOUR EXTERNAL REVIEWER / EXAMINER IN MIND



Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

UNISA university of south africa

Most important rule during writing is to remember the golden thread!

The Golden Thread – All About Structure

- Planning your argument (use Mindmaps (Video))
  - First your outline of your document – use tools such as FreeMind, Mind Manager or TheBrain
  - Then your outline of your Chapter / Sections
  - Then the outline of your paragraphs
  - Then the outline of your sentences

Structure

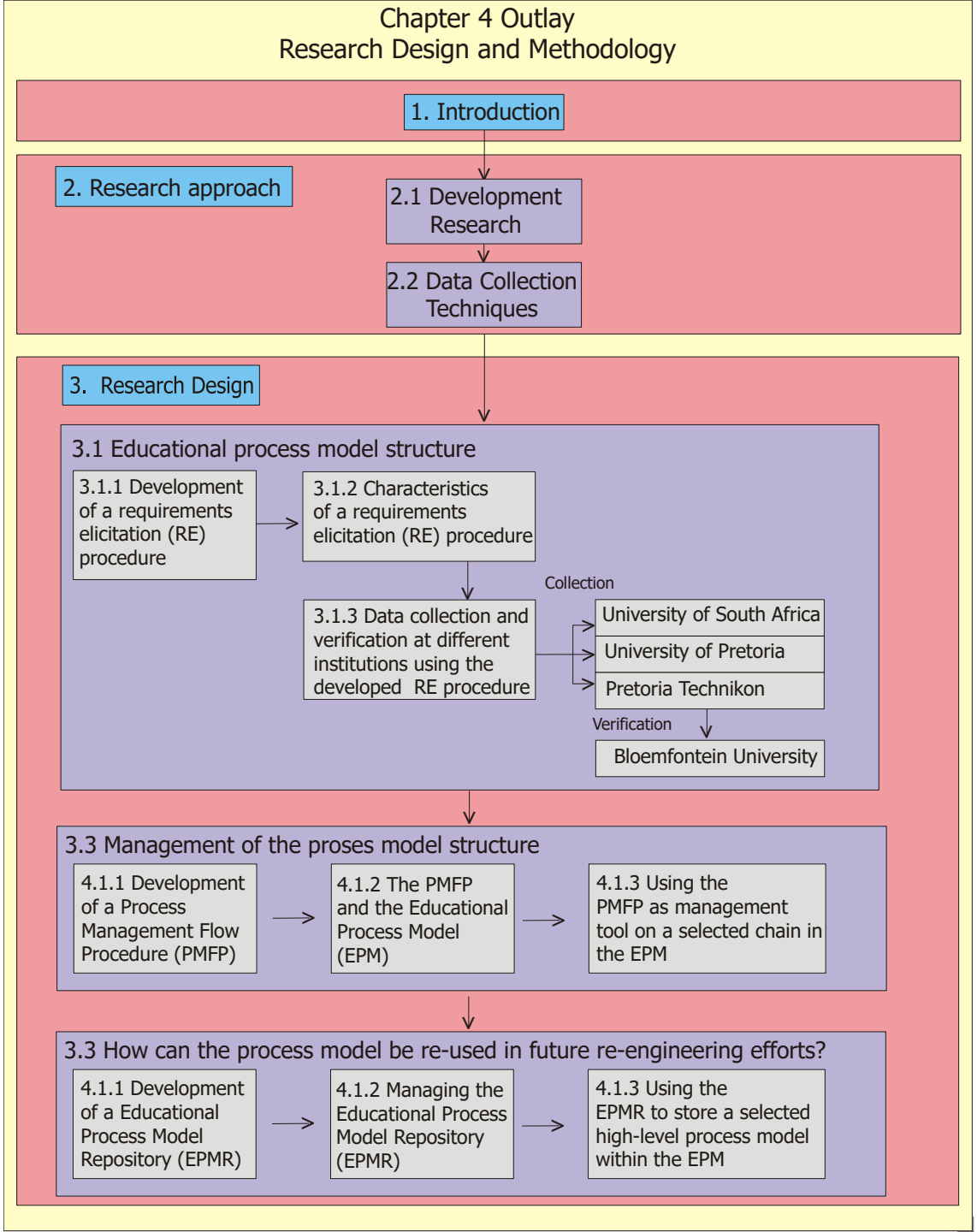
2. THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK 22

2.1 Introduction 22
2.2 Background information 22
2.2.1 The impact of the technological revolution on HEI 23
2.2.2 Re-engineering the processes in an HEI application domain 25
2.3 Process model structure 29
2.3.1 What is a process? 30
2.3.2 Process modelling 31
2.3.3 Process notation 32
2.3.4 Identification of the process model structure 36
2.3.4.1 Process model components identification 36
2.3.4.2 Construction of the process model structure 37
2.3.5 Establishing a generic process model structure 39
2.3.6 Process modelling tools 41
2.3.7 Overview: process model structure 43

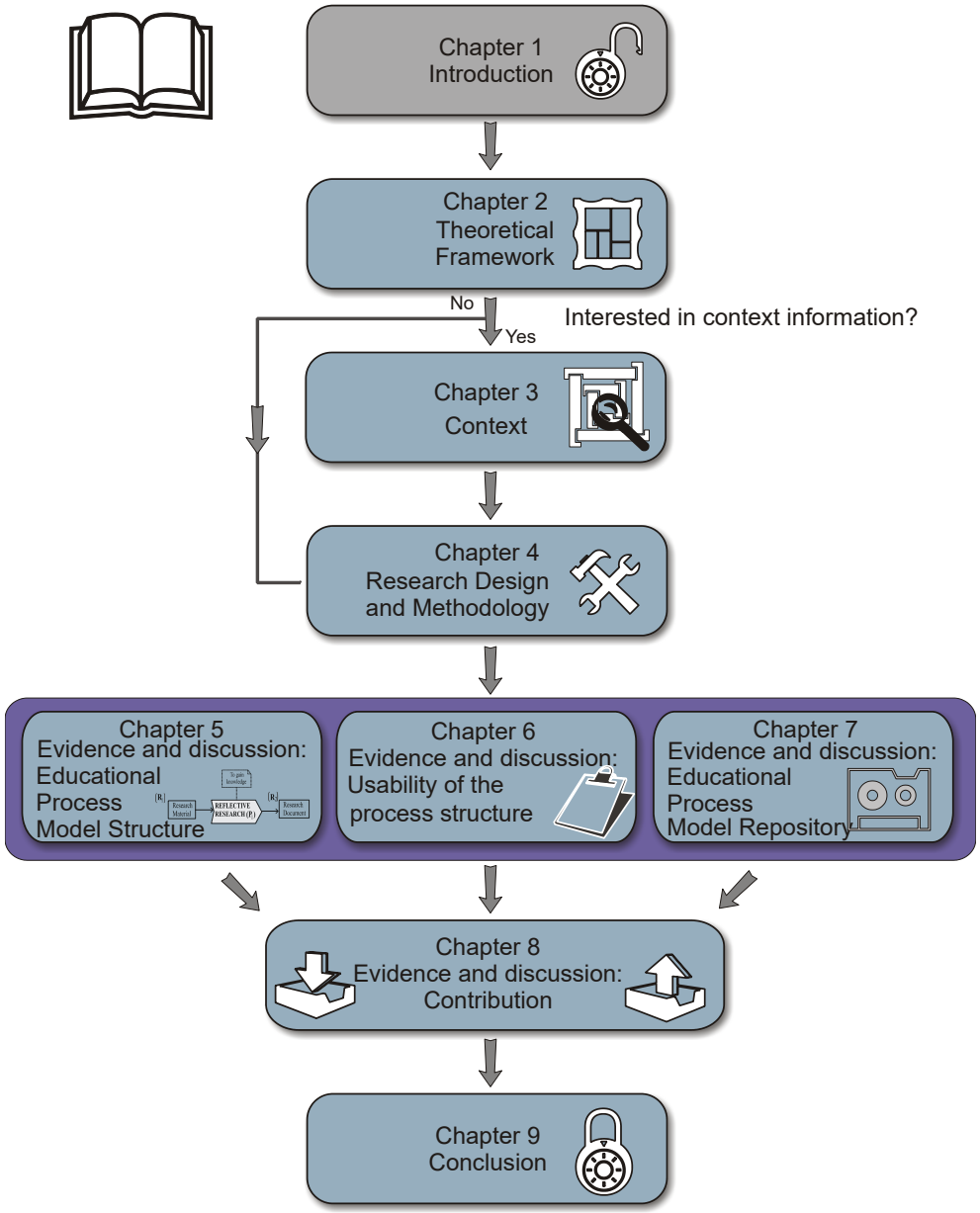
Make your text interesting

- Uninteresting text : Example 1
- Use Bullets, boxes, graphics: Example 2

- Draw up a **Thesis Map / Chapter Map**
  - **Assist in your own thinking and assist the externals thinking processes.**


Chapter 4 Outlay
Research Design and Methodology
1. Introduction
2. Research approach
2.1 Development Research
2.2 Data Collection Techniques
3. Research Design
3.1 Educational process model structure
3.1.1 Development of a requirements elicitation (RE) procedure
3.1.2 Characteristics of a requirements elicitation (RE) procedure
3.1.3 Data collection and verification at different institutions using the developed RE procedure
Collection
University of South Africa
University of Pretoria
Pretoria Technikon
Verification
Bloemfontein University
3.3 Management of the proses model structure
4.1.1 Development of a Process Management Flow Procedure (PMFP)
4.1.2 The PMFP and the Educational Process Model (EPM)
4.1.3 Using the PMFP as management tool on a selected chain in the EPM
3.3 How can the process model be re-used in future re-engineering efforts?
4.1.1 Development of a Educational Process Model Repository (EPMR)
4.1.2 Managing the Educational Process Model Repository (EPMR)
4.1.3 Using the EPMR to store a selected high-level process model within the EPM

Thesis Map


Chapter 1
Introduction
Chapter 2
Theoretical
Framework
No
Yes
Interested in context information?
Chapter 3
Context
Chapter 4
Research Design
and Methodology
Chapter 5
Evidence and discussion:
Educational
Process
Model Structure
Chapter 6
Evidence and discussion:
Usability of the
process structure
Chapter 7
Evidence and discussion:
Educational
Process
Model Repository
Chapter 8
Evidence and discussion:
Contribution
Chapter 9
Conclusion

Make your text interesting

- Uninteresting text : Example 1
- Use Bullets, boxes, graphics: Example 2

- Draw up a **Thesis Map / Chapter Map**
  - **Assist in your own thinking and assist the externals thinking processes.**

- Think like the external .. What looks nice – what makes text interesting?

Although it is relatively easy to illustrate the process of modelling in a book or at a lecture, in real life there are problems. It is importa to realize that there is no logical point at which level the detail stops. This is a pragmatic decision. Certainly, design teams can put too much effort into the development of the model. Some decisions are based on the way in which the data is used. An example of this could be entity occurences of persons who are female where they relate to:

- Patients in a hospital
- students at University
- readers in a library.

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO’s
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Scientific Writing

- Sweeping statements
  - I felt
  - Elicitation is all about
  - Requirements elicitation is becoming a big issue for companies that produce software.
  - It is important to note … says who?
  - Having read carefully about … eekhhh!

Scientific Writing

- Tense:
  - Use active voice.

Avoid starting sentences with "I" or "we": this pulls focus away from the scientific topic at hand.
Avoid using "I" or "we" when you're making a conjecture, whether it's substantiated or not. Everything you say should follow from logic, not from personal bias or subjectivity. Never use any emotive words in conjunction with "I" or "we" (e.g., "I believe," "we feel," etc.).
Never use "we" in a way that includes the reader (e.g., "here we see trait evolution in action"); the use of "we" in this context sets a condescending tone.
http://www.unc.edu/depts/wcweb/handouts/sciences.html

Scientific Writing

- Tense:
  - Use active voice.

Be direct. *A hit B* describes the event more concisely than *B was hit by A.* The passive is often used to conceal the identity of the person who is actually responsible for something unpleasant. An inspector might write: *It is felt that you have no grounds for complaint* when he is reluctant to admit plainly that it is he who feels that way himself.

Arguments for the use of “I”

Amir (2005)

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Scientific Writing

Type	Example
Judgmental	bad, good, terrible, nice, stupid, true , pure, ideal, simple
Absolute	perfect, all, none, must
Vague	most, today, yesterday, modern, soon, seems, seemingly, actually, really
Colloquial	nice, stupid, terrible, gross
Redundant	obviously, clearly,

Language

Phrases	
Colloquial	Due to… We were surprised to learn… In view of… In light of… Kind of… Something like… A lot of…
Vague	A number of… Just about… In terms of… Based on… Would seem to show…

Word/Term	**Problem**	**Suggested alternative**
Proof	Can you do that *mathematically?*	Evidence
Significant Probability	Have you done the statistics?	Salient, outstanding, clear Use the exact term

Language

Words often confused	Problem	Suggested alternative
affect effect effect	influence result accomplish	be affected by the effect of effect a change
accept except	receive exclude	accept an award all except you
allusion illusion	reference visual error	an allusion in the paper an optical illusion
complement compliment	the completing part praise	complementary angles thanks for the compliment
advise advice	verb noun	advise me take my advice
disinterested uninterested	fair unconcerned	a disinterested third party completely uninterested
principle principal	rule chief	the "Peter" principle a school principal

Language

Words often confused	Problem	Suggested alternative
number amount	countable objects uncountable	number of coins amount of money
many much	countable objects uncountable	many mistakes much water
fewer less	countable objects uncountable	fewer mistakes less water
personal personnel staff	belonging to me people generally workers	my personal computer military personnel my staff
formally formerly	according to form previously	you are formally invited as was formerly done
must should	obligatory suggestion	the iron must be earthed you should ask nicely
like as	for people and things for actions	he looks like me do as you are told
Normally Usually	according to a norm more often than not	Instances distributed normally It usually happens this way
Different Various	Can be separated from More than one	There are two different ways There are various types

KISS

- Keep your writing style simple and easy to understand ..

A quality learning system is the foundation of virtual distance learning. It represents not only a significant investment and a competitive edge for a particular learning institution, but is also crucial to the success of the learning process. The integration of the heritage systems and legacy data into a network-centric environment involves more than just connecting data and hardware to the Internet - it requires the ability to make intelligent trade-offs that extend the scope of, and harvest the investment in, these systems. The systems engineer must design a strategy for the implementation and maintenance of a quality learning system. This quality is parametrized by factors such as feasibility, schedule, flexibility and maintenance, chronological instability, and scalability and expandability. In this paper, we describe how these parameters affect the quality of a virtual learning system, and attempt to reduce unforeseen systems engineering problems when developing a new virtual learning system.

On Numbers

- In text, write out the numbers in words from one to nine, then use figures for numbers from 10 upwards.
- You may use numbers lower than 10 in the case of scientific units, numerals that include a decimal point or a fraction, and when you use the percentage sign, for example *5 kg*, *4.25, 4¼, 7%*.
- Never start a sentence with a number, write out the number in full.

Format

- Key variables for high legibility are font size, font and space between lines (“leading” pronounced “ledding”). A size of 11 pt is the generally recommended standard. Often tables and figures require a smaller font to make optimum use of space. Ensure that you do not use a size smaller than 9 pt since it becomes difficult to read. Use single space and one column only in documents.

Format

- The typeface for body text should be quiet, simple and regular to ensure that the eye moves easily from one word/sentence to the next. Generally, the serif fonts (a type with tiny strokes or projections at the end of each letter such as Times Roman as used in this example) look authoritative and official, but its narrow character makes it more suitable for newspaper columns..

Format

- The sans serif fonts such as the one used in this slide (Arial) are recommended for documents. They look good in any application. Sans serif fonts tend to be plain, unfussy and very compact, allowing the reader to focus on the content of the document. They make an especially strong impact in bold.

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Some nasty NO NOs

- Some mistakes:
  - This report will follow the same trend
  - More information can be found at – Rather: The interested reader may consult
  - Specified here are reasons … vs The following are reasons
  - It says that …– Carefull for IT .. What is IT?
  - Don’t ever get to familiar – e.g. telling stories …

NO NOs

- Be careful of:
  - Here are a number of reasons .. Vs The following are some of the reasons ..
  - Most times it is difficult …
  - As you can see in Figure 1 .. Vs In Figure 1 the concept is illustrated ..

Writing errors

- Consistency
  - Capitalization of words : Be consistent, if you start writing “Section” with a capital letter you should always do so.
  - Bullets, Lists
- References: According to Smith (Smith, 2004). This is wrong – should be According to Smith (2004)
- NEVER EVER EVER EVER reference Wikipedia!!!!!!

Some mistakes

- Consistency with page layout – always start on the left :

The company has in the past decade focused on a branch of avionics classified as health and usage monitoring systems or HUMS. A HUMS typically monitors various parameters to establish the status of the health or airworthiness of the aircraft and to record its usage or life consumption. The purpose of a HUMS is to improve safety and to provide data to facilitate the management of a fleet of aircraft.

In spite of limiting its focus, the company's level of benefit from software reuse remains limited. This situation is becoming a greater concern as the increase in competition in the industry translates into a demand for productivity and quality improvements.

A preliminary search revealed that most of the published software reuse success stories feature large organisations with ample resources, large R&D budgets and huge development

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Citation and plagiarism

Please note this warning! Plagiarism is perhaps the most common, and te most avoidable, reason an assignment or dissertation may be failed. To plagiarize is to present as your own work materials copied or closely paraphrased from someone else without acknowledging the original author. Whether published or unpublished materials, from a noted authority or from another student, directly appropriating the work of others without giving due and appropriate credit is plagiarism.

Part of the commitment of being a supervisor is to ensure that the work that you are doing are your own – at UNISA most of the work submitted within the School of Computing are send through TURNITIN where we can see the duplication from other material.

Chiwhawha, Gibson	Ontologies	36%		.pdf	60674627	02-11-08
Chimamiwa, Gibson 2	Ontologies Databases	24%		.pdf	60674823	02-11-08

Citation and plagiarism

This talk will not discuss the various popular citation styles, but it is essential to point out that anything that is not your own work and that is not properly cited amounts to plagiarism, which is tantamount to academic suicide. The more references you cite, however, the more you show that you have read the relevant literature, and that you are able to synthesize that (Cronje,2005).

On referencing

- Davenport (1993:5) defines a process as 'simply a structured, measured set of activities designed to produce a specified output for a particular customer or market'. The most important difference between the process and the product is that the process focuses on 'how' to do work in contrast to the product, which focuses on 'what' to do (Davenport, 1993).
- Hammer and Champy (1993) define the process as '… a collection of activities that takes one or more kinds of input and creates an output that is of value to the customer'.
- Harrington (1991) defines a process as 'any activity or group of activities that takes an input, adds value to it, and provides an output to an internal or external customer'.

On referencing

As indicated above, in a number of fields the classification of systems and the reusability thereof have proved to be an advantage. The identification of process model structures is not easy and is usually costly (Nikols, 2003). In the HEI application domain where change is inevitable to stay competitive, the identification of structures could be an advantage, as was stated in the early 1990s by Prupis (1992). If these structures can be reused across boundaries, this could not only benefit the internal structure of one HEI, but could also benefit organizations where it is not feasible to initiate expensive process re-engineering innovations. A reusable object is not worth much if the object is not available. The preservation and availability of objects are therefore important, through libraries in the case of objects (Budd, 1991), or repositories in the case of process models (Carr, 2003).

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs / Tables
- Some general recommendations

Paragraphs

• Find the main idea of each paragraph. • Summarise the whole piece in one sentence. • Write it down as concisely as possible. • Combine ideas and eliminate duplication. • Re-arrange sensibly.	• Remove redundancies • Change passive to active • Make adjectives • Change negative to positive • Use one word for many

From sentences to paragraphs

A paragraph is a collection of sentences that from a logical unit. The main sentence in the paragraph is one that summarizes the whole paragraph. It is called the *topic sentence.* The topic sentence is usually found at the beginning or at the end of the paragraph. There are a number of ways to link sentences together to form paragraphs. Mouton (2001, p. 127) mentions:

•Elaboration
•Reaffirmation
•Conclusions
•Contrasts

Paragraphs

General rules for paragraphs

- One idea per paragraph
- Arranged in logical order
- Contains all information needed
- Contains no unnecessary information

How to structure paragraphs for easy reading

- Determine the main idea.
- Find supporting information
- Arrange in order

Overview

- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs / Tables
- Some general recommendations

Tables

Synthesize don’t summarize

Tables are useful instruments for synthesizing the work of a number of researchers. Consider this example by Miller (2003:8).

1. Generation X (Xer)	People born between 1961 and 1981.
1. Generation Y	Children born at the end of the 1970s.
1. Millennial Generation	Children born since the early 1980s.
1. Oh-Oh teens	Children who are teenagers during the Oh-Oh (2000 - 2009) years and born mainly between 1989 and 1994. Howe and Strauss referred to this group as the Millennial Generation.
1. Net Generation	Many of those born between 1977 and 1997 have become the Net Generation influenced by intensive Internet usage.
1. Nintendo Generation	Children between the ages of three and 18, and entering school 'today' influenced by the Nintendo technology.
1. Children of the Chaos Generation	Children influenced by a non-linear culture, probably since the middle 80s.

Table 3: Miller's synthesis in table form. (Miller 2003:8)
(Cobb, 1998; Howe, 1998; Lankard, 1995; Nintendo, n.d.; Rushkoff, 1999; Tapscott, 1999; Zoba, 1997)

Some mistakes made in Tables/Figures

In Table 1 a summary of .. is found (no description).

In Figure 1 a data flow diagram of … is given.

There must be a description of the table/figure.

- Figures in text please … Except if explicitly stated by journal

- Figure/Table directly after you have referenced it.

THERE MUST BE A DESCRIPTION OF WHAT EVER IS IN THIS TABLE/FIGURE.

Overview

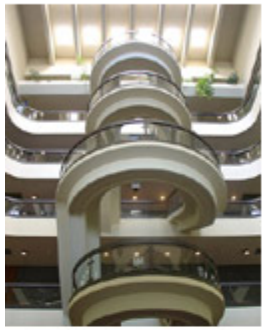
- Structure
- Scientific Writing
- Language
- Some nasty NO-NO's
- Citations
- Paragraphs
- Some general recommendations

Some General Recommendations

dress http://bibinf.unisa.ac.za/infoweb/sbj-db-grp-placements-list.html?placement=5 Go

oogle Go Bookmarks PageRank 15 blocked Check Settings

unisa library | ask a librarian | friends | branches | library tour | hours | staff | news | faq | myUnisa | catalogue | search for information | services | instruction | enquiries | site map |



email: library webmaster

o box 392
unisa
003

unisa call centre:
0861 670 411 (nationally)
-27 11 670-9000
internationally)
erms and conditions,
egislation &
© university of south africa

ast modified: 2006/02/06

subject databases: theses and dissertations - (on-campus)

Sabinet Online	Current and Completed Research	>> multi-disciplinary	bibliographic	instruction
	Database of African Theses and Dissertations	>> multi-disciplinary	bibliographic	
ProQuest	Dissertations and Theses	>> multi-disciplinary	bibliographic	instruction
Sabinet Online	Navtech	>> accounting & auditing >> taxation	bibliographic	instruction
Sabinet Online	NDLTD (Theses and Dissertations)	>> multi-disciplinary	partly full-text	instruction
NRF	Nexus Database System	>> multi-disciplinary	bibliographic	instruction
Theses Canada Thèses	Theses Canada Portal	>> multi-disciplinary	partly full-text	instruction
Sabinet Online	UCTD	>> multi-disciplinary	bibliographic	instruction
university of south africa LIBRARY	UnisaETD: electronic theses and dissertations	>> multi-disciplinary	full-text	

Some General Recommendations

- In writing the dissertation/thesis – begin by reading some of your supervisor's students work – ask your supervisor.
- Use GRAPHICS to illustrate. People are graphical inclined.
- Get hold of some evaluation material – e.g. be a reviewer at conferences if you are writing an article

Some General Recommendations

Reviewer Name:		Manuscript Number:	
Date Review:			
Title of Manuscript:			

Which category describes this manuscript?

	Practice/Application/Case
	Study/Experience Report
	Research/Technology
	Survey/Tutorial/How-To
	Other (please specify)

Are the title, abstract, and keywords appropriate? Please comment.

	Yes
	No
Comments	

Rate the paper in each of the following areas (1 = low ; 5 = high):

	1	2	3	4	5
Relevance to journal					
Technical content					
Originality					
Significance/Value to international audience					
Clarity/Organisation					
Mechanics/Grammar					

GENERAL COMMENTS

Discuss the contribution made by the manuscript:	
Comment on the technical content of the manuscript:	
Comment on the organisational and writing style of the manuscript:	
Comment on the appropriateness for the journal (timeliness, broad appeal, etc):	
Comment on the evaluation methodology used (if applicable):	

Does the manuscript contain sufficient and appropriate references? Please comment.

	References are sufficient and appropriate
	Important references are missing; more references are needed
	Number of references are excessive
Comments:	

Suggestions for improvement to the paper:	

Final Recommendation:

	Definitely accept
	Accept only if room
	Borderline
	Reject (poor quality)
	Other (please specify)

Some General Recommendations

- In writing the dissertation/thesis – begin by reading some of your supervisor's students work – Unisa Library.
- Use GRAPHICS to illustrate. People are graphical inclined.
- Get hold of some evaluation material – e.g. be a reviewer at conferences if you are writing an article
- Ask your supervisor for an evaluation form used for a thesis/dissertation.

Some General Recommendations

- Another common mistake in writing a dissertation is not explaining different terms the writer uses.
- Use a reference tool such as Zotero, Mendeley
- Get a technical reader …

Working effectively

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z7e7gtU3PHY&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

Questions?

Some References

References

Burrell, G. & Morgan, G. 1979. *Sociological Paradigms and organizational analysis*. London: Heinemann.
Cronje, J (2006), Academic Writing by Numbers, Pretoria.
Mouton, J. (2001) *How to succeed in your Masters' and Doctoral Studies.* Pretoria: Van Schaiks

Helpful Links

The Graduate School of Education and Human Development, Doctoral Student Services Web Guide-http://gwu.edu/~docgsehd
APA-Style Helper (software)- www.apa.org/apa-style
PhinishedD: ABD Discussion and Support Group- www.phinished.org
Advice on Research and Writing-
www.cs.cmu.edu/afs/cs.cmu.edu/user/mleone/web/how-to.html
Association for Support of Graduate Students- www.asgs.org
Electronic Reference Formats Recommended by the American Psychological Association- www.apa.org/journals/webref.html